conflict between West Bengal Governor Dhankhar and Chief Minister Mamata Banerjee became so bitter that the state government wrote to the Centre multiple times requesting Dhankhar's recall. But even after Dhankhar's elevation to the vice-presidency, tensions persisted under his successor Bose. According to Speaker Biman Banerjee, the Raj Bhavan has yet to give assent to 23 bills since 2015. However, Raj Bhavan sources claim that the governor has assented to eight of these bills, while



"Governors blocking legislative business are engaging in political theatre that damages governance and the Constitution"

FAIZAN MUSTAFA
VC, Chanakya National Law University

11 have been sent for the President's consideration. Telangana faced a similar situation when Governor Tamilisai Soundararajan delayed approval for several bills passed by the state legislature. The state government moved the Supreme Court in March 2023, accusing the governor of creating a "constitutional impasse". "When a governor deliberately sits on bills passed by an elected assembly, it is no longer a constitutional disagreement—it becomes an act of democratic sabotage, a betrayal of the people's mandate," says Singhvi.

What was designed as an apolitical bridge between the Union and states has become a choke point where legislative will often stalls. "Governors refusing to read cabinet-approved speeches, interfering in university appointments or blocking legislative business without reason are not engaging in

THE OTHER BATTLES

ANI



PUNJAB

The relationship between former Punjab governor **Banwarilal Purohit** and Chief Minister **Bhagwant Mann** was marked by confrontation. Disputes arose over Purohit's visits to border districts and role in legislative processes. In September 2022, the governor withdrew consent for a special assembly session called by the AAP government, leading to charges of constitutional overreach. More tension emerged over a bill seeking to remove Purohit as chancellor of state universities, which was declined by the President.

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TELANGANA

The tenure of **Tamilisai Soundararajan** as Telangana governor (2019–2024) was marked by conflict with former CM **K. Chandrashekar Rao**. Clashes erupted over legislative delays, most notably when she withheld assent to the TSRTC merger bill in 2023, sparking protests by transport workers. The governor also claimed she was excluded from official events, including the state's budget session. Soundararajan, a former BJP leader, was often accused by the BRS of politicising her constitutional role.

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MAHARASHTRA

In June 2022, a rebellion within the Shiv Sena led by Eknath Shinde triggered a political crisis in Maharashtra. Governor **Bhagat Singh Koshyari**'s directive for a floor test prompted the then chief minister **Uddhav Thackeray** to resign. Shinde then formed a government with BJP support. In May 2023, the Supreme Court criticised the governor's actions, stating that he did not act as per the law, but did not reinstate Thackeray's government, as he had resigned voluntarily.

PTI



JHARKHAND

In February 2023, Jharkhand CM **Hemant Soren** accused Governor **C.P. Radhakrishnan** of conspiring with the Centre to orchestrate his arrest. His nominee Champai Soren waited nearly 48 hours before being invited to form a government, a delay the JMM claimed was a BJP ploy to engineer defections. But Radhakrishnan denied the allegations. In August 2022, former governor Ramesh Bais refused to disclose an EC report on Soren in an office-of-profit case, sparking a political storm. Both governors have also withheld assent to key state legislation.